

PAUL NOVOSAD

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Professional Positions

Associate Professor Dartmouth College	2020–
Assistant Professor Dartmouth College	2013–2020
Founder Development Data Lab	2019–

Education

PhD in Political Economy and Government, Harvard University	2013
MPA International Development, Harvard University	2004
BA English, University of Calgary	1999

Publications / In Press

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1. Sam Asher (R) Kritarth Jha (R) **Paul Novosad** (R) Anjali Adukia (R) Brandon Tan, “Residential Segregation and Unequal Access to Local Public Services in India: Evidence from 1.2m Neighborhoods,” Conditionally accepted at *American Economic Review*.
 2. Sam Asher, Eni Iljazi, Catriona Farquharson, and **Paul Novosad**, “Access to Opportunity in the Sciences: Evidence from the Nobel Laureates,” Conditionally accepted at *Review of Economics and Statistics*.
 3. Elliott Ash, Sam Asher, Aditi Bhowmick, Sandeep Bhupatiraju, Daniel Chen, Tanaya Devi, Christoph Goessman, **Paul Novosad**, and Bilal Siddiqi, “In-group bias in the Indian judiciary: Evidence from 5 million criminal cases,” Forthcoming at *Review of Economics and Statistics*.
 4. Sam Asher, **Paul Novosad**, and Charlie Rafkin, “Intergenerational Mobility in India: New Measures and Estimates Across Time, Space, and Communities,” *AEJ: Applied* 16:2 (2024).
 5. Sam Asher, **Paul Novosad**, “Rent-Seeking and Criminal Politicians: Evidence from Mining Booms,” *Review of Economics and Statistics* 105: 1 (2023).
 6. Prabhat Jha, Yashwant Deshmukh, Chinmay Tumbe, Wilson Suraweera, Aditi Bhowmick, Sankalp Sharma, **Paul Novosad**, Sze Hang Fu, Leslie Newcombe, Hellen Gelband, and Patrick Brown, “COVID mortality in India: National survey data and health facility deaths,” *Science* 10.1126/science.abm5154 (2022).
 7. **Paul Novosad**, Charlie Rafkin, and Sam Asher, “Mortality Change Among Less Educated Americans,” *AEJ: Applied* 14:4 (2022).
 8. Aarushi Kalra and **Paul Novosad**, “Impacts of regional lockdown policies on COVID-19 transmission in India in 2020,” *Economics and Politics Weekly* 57:14 (2022).
 9. Sam Asher, Aditi Bhowmick, Alison Campion, Tobias Lunt, **Paul Novosad**, “Big, Open Data for Development: A Vision for India,” *India Policy Forum* (2021, not peer reviewed).
 10. Sam Asher, Toby Lunt, Ryu Matsuura, **Paul Novosad**, “Development Research at High Geographic Resolution: An Analysis of Night Lights, Firms, and Poverty in India using the SHRUG Open Data Platform,” *World Bank Economic Review* 35:4 (2021).
 11. Rebecca Cai, **Paul Novosad**, Vaidehi Tandel, Sam Asher, and Anup Malani, “Representative Estimates of COVID-19 Infection Fatality Rates from Four Locations in India,” *BMJ Open* 9:1 (2021).
 12. Sam Asher, **Paul Novosad**, “Rural Roads and Local Economic Development,” *American Economic Review* 110:3 (2020).

13. Anjali Adukia, Sam Asher, and **Paul Novosad**, “Educational Investment Responses to Economic Opportunity: Evidence from Indian Road Construction,” *AEJ: Applied* 12:1 (2020).
14. Sam Asher, Teevrat Garg, and **Paul Novosad**, “The Ecological Footprint of Transportation Infrastructure,” *Economic Journal* 130:629 (2020).
15. **Paul Novosad**, Radhika Jain, Alison Champion, and Sam Asher, “COVID-19 mortality effects of underlying health conditions in India: a modelling study,” *BMJ Open* 10:e043165 (2020).
16. **Paul Novosad** and Eric Werker, “Who Runs the International System? Nationality and Leadership in the United Nations Secretariat,” *The Review of International Organizations* 14:1 (2019).
17. Sam Asher and **Paul Novosad**, “Politics and Local Economic Growth: Evidence from India,” *AEJ: Applied* 9:1 (2017).

Work in Progress

1. Sam Asher, Aditi Bhowmick, Maurizio Bussolo, and **Paul Novosad**, “Cultural capital and access to opportunity: Evidence from subcaste norms in India,” Working paper.
2. Sam Asher, Alison Champion, Doug Gollin, and **Paul Novosad**, “The Long-run Development Impacts of Agricultural Productivity Gains: Evidence from Irrigation Canals in India,” Revision requested at *Review of Economic Studies*.
3. Aditi Bhowmick (✉) Sara Sethia (✉) Jonah Rexer (✉) **Paul Novosad** (✉) Maurizio Bussolo (✉) Sam Asher, “The Female Urban Mobility Advantage in South Asia,” Working paper.

On Hold or Retired

1. Sam Asher and **Paul Novosad**, “Digging for Development: Economic Impacts of Mining Booms,” Working paper.
2. Anup Malani, **Paul Novosad**, et al., “Adaptive Control of COVID-19 Outbreaks in India: Local, Gradual, and Trigger-based Exit Paths from Lockdown,” Working paper.
3. Sam Asher and **Paul Novosad**, “The Impacts of Local Control over Political Institutions: Evidence from State Splitting in India,” Working paper.
4. Sam Asher, Karan Nagpal and **Paul Novosad**, “The Cost of Distance: Geography and Governance in Rural India,” Working paper.
5. Denis Nekipelov, **Paul Novosad**, and Stephen P. Ryan, “Moment Forests,” NBER Working Paper No. 22976.
6. Sam Asher, **Paul Novosad** and Charlie Rafkin, “Getting Signal from Interval Data: Theory and Applications to Mortality and Intergenerational Mobility,” Working paper.

Papers from Past Lives

1. Leyenaar, J., **Novosad P.**, Ferrer K., Thahane, L., Mohapi E., Schutze G., Kline M.. “Early Clinical Outcomes in Children Enrolled in HIV Infection, Care and Treatment in Lesotho,” *The Pediatric Infectious Diseases Journal*, Vol. 29:4.
2. Hoang Lan Anh, Castella J.C., **Novosad P.** “Social networks and information access: Implications for agricultural extension in a rice farming community in northern Vietnam.” *Agriculture and Human Values: Journal of the Agriculture, Food and Human Values Society*, Vol. 23:4.
3. Castella J.C., Boissau S., Nguyen Hai Thanh, **Novosad P.** “Impact of forestland allocation on land use in a mountainous province of Vietnam,” *Land Use Policy* 23.
4. Castella J.C., Gevraise V., **Novosad P.** “Centralized planning and economic reforms in a mountain region of Vietnam,” *Journal of Contemporary Asia*, Vol. 35:2.

Awards and Research Funding

2026 World Bank: Urban Labor Markets in Low- and Middle-Income Countries

2025 International Growth Centre: Fostering sustainable urbanization

2025 Structural Transformation and Growth (STEG): Urban Data Center

2025 European Research Council grant (to Co-PI Sam Asher): Culture and Economic Change in India

2024 World Bank: Cultural Distance and Economic Opportunity

2023 World Bank: Intergenerational Mobility Across South Asia

2022 India-Swiss Joint Research Program Grant: Big Data for Justice in India

2021 Weiss Fund: The Long Run Impacts of Investments in Agricultural Productivity

2021 Dartmouth Innovation and Advancement Award: Gender Inequality and Social Norms

2021 World Bank: Intergenerational Mobility in South Asia

2021 STEG Large Research Grant: Structural Transformation and Gender Norms in the Long Run

2020 PEDL Exploratory Research Grant: Economic Impact of Mining Booms

2020 Omidyar Foundation: Data Platform Support for the Government of India

2019 World Bank Agriculture Global Practice: Long-Run Impacts of Canals

2019 Emergent Ventures: A Scalable Socioeconomic Data Platform for India

2016 IGC Central: Rapid Urbanization, Rural-to-Urban Migration and Rural Development

2015 IGC Tanzania: The Cost of Rural Road Construction in Tanzania

2015 IGC Central: Impacts of Rural Roads in India

2014 IZA/DFID Growth and Labour Markets in Low Income Countries: Urban Geography of Entrepreneurship and Growth

2013 Private Enterprise in Low-Income Countries, Centre for European Policy Research: Urban Geography of Entrepreneurship

2011 Merit Fellowship, Graduate School of Arts and Sciences, Harvard

2009 Warburg Fund Award, Department of Economics, Harvard

Invited Presentations

2014: Cornell University (Development and Public Economics Seminar Series), NEUDC, World Bank (South Asia Decentralization Series), Indian Planning Commission.

2015: World Bank (Microeconomics Group), CSAE, NEUDC, Yale (Leitner Seminar), IFPRI (Applied Microeconomics Seminar).

2016: IGC Cities (London), Barcelona Summer Forum, Harvard (Cities and Development Conference), World Bank (Conference on Inequality), NEUDC, Boston University.

2017: Harris School of Public Policy, Yale (Conference on Agriculture, Structural Transformation and Development), Harvard (Cities and Development Conference), Journées Louis-Andre Gerard-Varet (Aix-Marseilles), Barcelona Summer Forum, World Bank, Berkeley (Political Economy Seminar), UCSD, World Bank (IZA Labor Markets Conference, NEUDC, BREAD / NBER Development, Center for Policy Research (Delhi), Indian Ministry of Rural Development.

2018: Fordham University (Economics Seminar), Stanford (Conference on Indian Economic Policy), Paris School of Economics (India-China Conference), Barcelona Summer Forum, Yale (India Migration Conference), NBER Economics of Education, University of Michigan (Ford School of Public Policy Economics Seminar).

2019: Georgetown University (Economics Seminar), Johns Hopkins SAIS (Cities Development Workshop), Statistics Norway, World Bank (Pre-APSA Political Economy Conference), McGill (Economics Seminar), Harvard (Cities Development Conference), NEUDC, Stanford (Centre for Population Health Sciences), Indian Statistical Institute (Delhi)

2020: NBER Summer Institute Public Economics, SUNY Binghamton, Urban Economics Association, Royal Bank of India / Cafral

2021: NBER Conference on Mortality, ETH Zurich, University of Ottawa, ACM, India Policy Forum, Center for Advanced Study on India at Penn, Yale, Trinity Dublin, UK FCDO, Ashoka

2022: Yale, UCSD, NBER Summer Institute Development, BREAD, University of Maryland, NBER Development

2023: University of Pittsburgh, University of Houston, USC, London School of Economics, Congressional Budget Office

2024: Brown, University of Wyoming, Wharton Business School, Yale YRISE Conference, Utah Business Economics Conference, Harvard

2025: Notre Dame, Opportunity Insights, Boston University, University of British Columbia

2026: George Washington University

Professional Activities

Referee: American Economic Review, Quarterly Journal of Economics, Journal of Political Economy, Review of Economic Studies, American Economic Journal: Applied Economics, American Economic Journal: Economic Policy, American Political Science Review, Economic Development and Cultural Change, Journal of Development Economics, Review of Economics and Statistics, among others

Co-organizer: Cities and Development Conference (since 2018), Dartmouth College External Applied Seminar (since 2016)

Conference reviewer: NEUDC (since 2014), Urban Economics Association Annual Conference (since 2022)

Member: BREAD, NBER Development, International Growth Centre

Creator / Maintainer: The SHRUG data platform (created and maintained since 2018), www.devdatalab.org/shrug

Predoctoral Experience

2007-08 Expert Group on Advanced Market Commitments, Analyst

2005-07 Government of Lesotho Ministry of Finance, Economic Advisor

2005-07 Baylor College of Medicine (Lesotho), Medical Software Developer

2004-05 Environment Canada, Policy Analyst

2001-02 International Rice Research Institute (Vietnam), Research Assistant

2000-01 Codefast.com Software Research Corporation, Software Engineer